

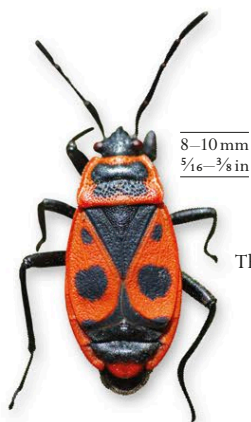
» TRUE BUGS



6–8 mm
¼–⅜ in

SCARLET SHIELD BUG
Eurydema dominulus
F: Pentatomidae

This European species, which can be red or orange, feeds on plants of the cress family and can be a pest of brassicas.



8–10 mm
⅝–⅜ in

FIRE BUG
Pyrrhocoris apterus
F: Pyrrhocoridae

This unmistakable black and red bug is a gregarious, flightless species widespread in C. and S. Europe. It feeds on seeds.



1.2–1.4 cm
½ in

COMMON GREEN SHIELD BUG
Palomena prasina
F: Pentatomidae

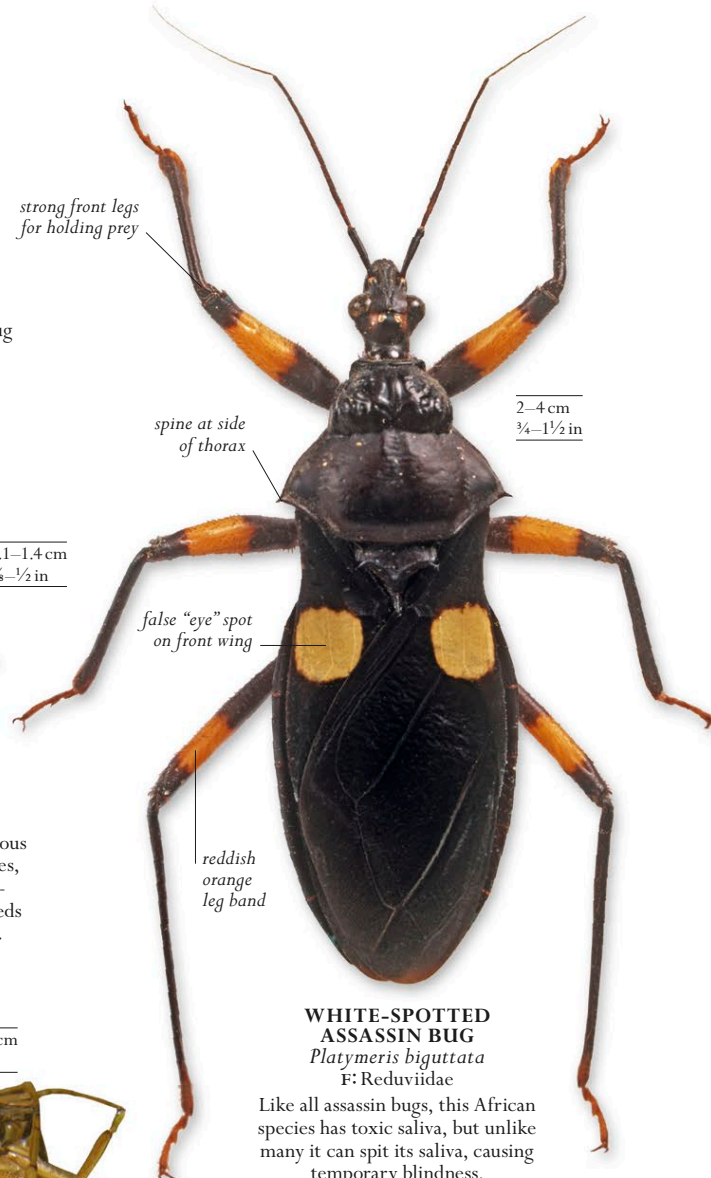
This bug is very common and widespread across Europe. It feeds on a wide range of plants and can be a minor pest.



1.1–1.4 cm
¾–½ in

FOREST BUG
Pentatoma rufipes
F: Pentatomidae

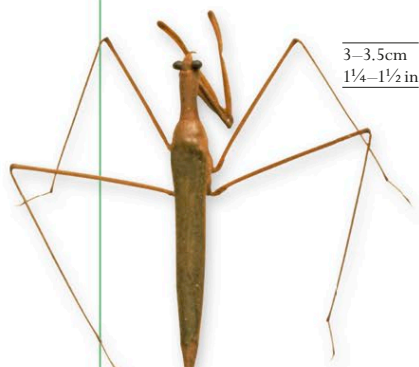
Found on a range of deciduous trees, this European species, recognizable by its blunt-shouldered appearance, feeds on sap and small insects.



2–4 cm
¾–1½ in

WHITE-SPOTTED ASSASSIN BUG
Platyeris biguttata
F: Reduviidae

Like all assassin bugs, this African species has toxic saliva, but unlike many it can spit its saliva, causing temporary blindness.



3–3.5 cm
1¼–1½ in

WATER STICK INSECT
Ranatra linearis
F: Nepidae

Using its specialized, long front legs to catch prey, including small fish, this slender bug favours deeper, well-vegetated pools.



1.8–2.2 cm
¾–1 in

WATER SCORPION
Nepa cinerea
F: Nepidae

This aquatic bug crawls about in the margins of shallow pools to catch small prey. It breathes through a long respiratory tail.



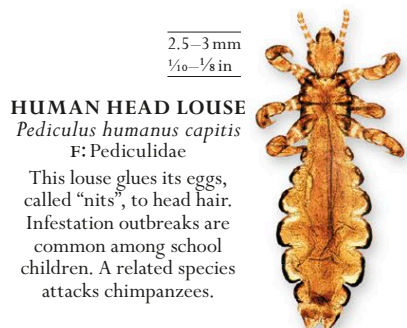
1.3–1.7 cm
½–¾ in

COMMON BACKSWIMMER
Notonecta glauca
F: Notonectidae

Found in ponds, lakes, canals, and ditches in Europe, this species is capable of taking vertebrate prey such as tadpoles and small fish. The underside faces up as it swims.

PARASITIC LICE

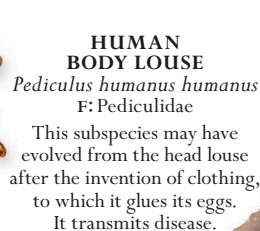
These wingless insects of the order Phthiraptera are ectoparasites, living on the bodies of birds and mammals. Their mouthparts are modified for chewing skin fragments or sucking blood, and their legs for gripping tightly to hair or feathers.



2.5–3 mm
⅓–⅜ in

HUMAN HEAD LOUSE
Pediculus humanus capitis
F: Pediculidae

This louse glues its eggs, called "nits", to head hair. Infestation outbreaks are common among school children. A related species attacks chimpanzees.



HUMAN BODY LOUSE
Pediculus humanus humanus
F: Pediculidae

This subspecies may have evolved from the head louse after the invention of clothing, to which it glues its eggs. It transmits disease.



2.5–3 mm
⅓–⅜ in

CHICKEN BODY LOUSE
Menacanthus stramineus
F: Menoponidae

Found worldwide as an ectoparasite of chickens, infestations of this pale, flattened chewing louse can cause feather loss and infection.



1–2 mm
⅓–⅜ in

GOAT LOUSE
Damalinia caprae
F: Trichodectidae

Found worldwide on goats, this biting louse can also survive for a few days on sheep but is not able to breed on them.

